



Windows 7
is all set to launch by the
end of 2009



Symantec
recently launched Norton
Utilities 2009



LG
launches 5.9-mm thick
LED TVs

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computer niggles and nags are dealt with here!

Don't know what's wrong!

I don't know what's wrong with my external hard disk. I found many folders hidden within folders. I haven't created these folders nor have I got them from the internet. The folders are created again when I transfer videos from my computer to my external drive. When I checked the folder properties, it says that it consumes 22 GB of space, but there isn't any change in the remaining space. I cannot delete the folders either. Every time I try, it says that it is in use and cannot be executed. I want to delete this folder, but I don't want to format my hard disk. Can you help me? I've captured a screenshot of the folder's content.

Ashish Mathew

The problem you have is due to a virus or worm. You might have caught this from the internet or an infected flash drive. The only way you can delete a folder without removing the virus is to use an application called Unlocker (<http://ccollomb.free.fr/unlocker/>). Once you've installed it, right-click

on the folder in Windows Explorer and click on Unlocker. You can then kill all the processes that are accessing the folder. Then, quickly delete the folder. You still have to remove the virus causing all the trouble. Install a good antivirus program or run an online virus scan from a site such as Trend Micro HouseCall (<http://housecall.trendmicro.com>) or BitDefender Online Scanner (www.bitdefender.com/scan8/ie.html)

Dial-up Internet not working properly

My PC uses an Intel Pentium 4 processor and an internal modem for my MTNL internet connection. Often, I'm unable to connect to the internet. However, at times it works just fine. What could be the problem and how do I rectify it? I have Windows XP.

Rajesh Seth

The problem could lie in a number of places. The internet connection itself might be at fault if there is a disturbance in your telephone line. In this case, inform the service provider about it, asking them to fix it. Also, update the

modem drivers from the manufacturer's site.

Should I be upgrading?

I want to upgrade my PC. The configuration I now have is an AMD Athlon 64 3500+, a Gigabyte GA-K8N51GMF motherboard, Hitachi SATA2 160GB HDD, 512 MB x 2 dual-channel DDR 400 and Samsung DVD writer.

I read my motherboard manual and it says that the board supports Athlon 64 x2 dual-core processors. If I change my processor and increase my memory to 2 GB, how much of a performance improvement can I expect? Secondly, what is the fastest processor compatible with my motherboard. Also, how much do I have to pay for the memory and processor? Is upgrading a wise idea or not?

Mandeep Singh Sandhu

Your motherboard supports 939-pin AMD processors, so you should be able to use any of the 939-pin Athlon X2 processors. Some of the newer AMD Athlon x2 processors and all of the Phenom line of processors use the new AM2 socket. The

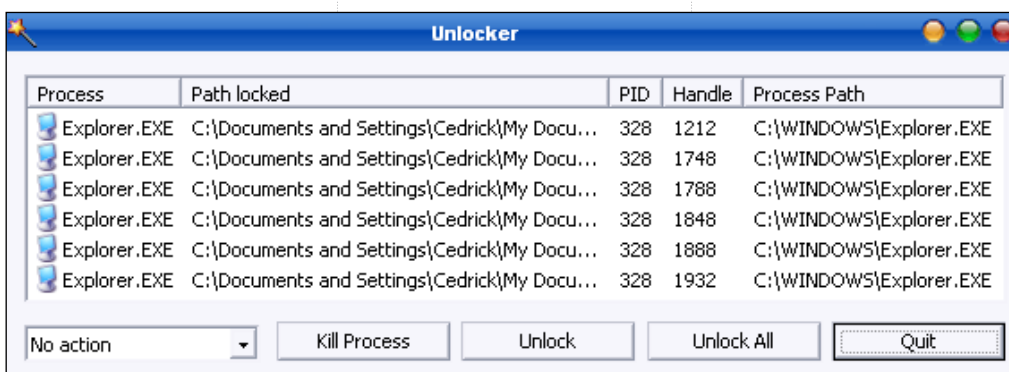
Athlon x2 4800+ is the fastest processor available in the 939-pin configuration. The dual-core 4800+ will give you a substantial performance jump, but it depends on why you need the performance. Your new configuration after upgrading will still be rather outdated, so spending a lot on it isn't recommended. Finding the 939-pin processors might be difficult as well, so we can't give you an accurate price for it. DDR1 RAM that you would need is also more expensive than DDR2 RAM. We suggest going in for a new setup altogether. If you just need a little boost in performance, don't spend more than Rs. 4,000 to Rs. 5,000 on the upgrade.

Keep getting NTLDR errors on bootup

My computer keeps telling me that NTLDR is missing. I also get a message saying that my computer is beginning to dump data. When I restart, it says NTLDR is missing.

I have been fixing this problem by calling the computer guy, but after a few days, the same problem returns. I have called the computer person some 5 to 6 times in the past few months. He comes and formats my system every time to fix the problem. In the May issue, I saw your QnA column in which I got the answer for the NTLDR problem. The computer repair person said that he had fixed my problem using the same method. After this, I face the same problem again after just a few days. I really don't know how to get rid of this problem.

If you continue to face this problem, it might be because the file NTLDR



Unlocker allows locked files to be moved or deleted